



Playdough

Make a batch of homemade playdough and help your baby squeeze, press, and form the dough into all sorts of shapes. If you make some animals, describe what you are doing, and make the noise of the animal. Make a couple more batches in other bright colors if this becomes a favorite activity.

For 1 batch of colored playdough

- ✿ 3 cups flour
- ✿ 2 tbsp cornstarch
- ✿ 1 cup salt
- ✿ 1 cup cold water with 2 tsp liquid natural food coloring added
- ✿ 2 tsp vegetable oil

Put all the ingredients in a large bowl and combine with a spoon. When it forms a dough, put it onto a board and knead it with your hands until it takes on the look and consistency of playdough. Store in an airtight bag for up to 1 week.

Memory game

hide ball

Use three upside down plastic cups and a small ball. Show your baby the ball, then hide it under a cup as he watches you. Encourage him to point to or hit the cup with the hidden ball and praise him if he picks the right one—he's building his understanding of object permanence. As you repeat the game and he becomes practiced at finding the ball, try hiding it under a different cup.

